

AIBOS OGASAWARA FISHING GUIDE

Ogasawara Fishing Guide

VIP Fishing Hospitality Operations Manual

Hahajima, Ogasawara Islands | June 2026

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Part 1

Welcome to the Water

Umi e Youkoso



1.1 You Are an Angler

You are not a spectator. You are not a passenger. From the moment you step onto that boat or walk across those rocks, **you are an angler** — and that word carries weight. An angler reads the water, respects the ocean, anticipates what comes next, and moves with purpose. On this trip, you are also something more: you are a hospitality professional who happens to be holding a fishing rod.

This guide will teach you everything you need to know. When you are standing on volcanic rock in 30-degree heat with a rod in one hand and a net in the other, you will not have time to look things up. Your preparation is your lifeline.

1.2 Ogasawara: Your Fishing Ground

The Ogasawara Islands sit roughly 1,000 km south of Tokyo — a UNESCO World Heritage site of volcanic islands surrounded by some of the most productive fishing waters in Japan. You will be based on **Hahajima**.

Ogasawara in June

Air: 26-30C, extreme humidity. Ocean: 25-27C. UV: Extreme. Currents: Strong near reefs.
Resupply: ZERO — ferry 1-2x/week. Medical evacuation: near-impossible. Nearest hospital:
24hr boat ride.

1.3 Your Mission: VIP Fishing Hospitality

You work for AIBOS under AEGIS standards. **Perfection is the baseline**. Nobody stands idle. Your mission: ensure Watanabe-san, Nagatani-san, and guests have an extraordinary fishing experience — lines baited, drinks full, gear maintained, safety constant.

1.4 How to Use This Guide

Ten parts + appendices. Parts 1-2: mindset. Parts 3-4: tackle and skills. Part 5: fishing scenarios. Parts 6-7: VIP care and gear maintenance. Parts 8-9: safety and rules. Part 10: training. Appendices: laminate-ready reference cards. Read front to back, then keep it close.

Part 2

Your Mindset — 6 Principles

Kodo Gensoku

Memorize these six principles. They apply everywhere — fishing, serving, packing, standing on the dock.

#1 Act Ahead, Never Stand Idle

Sakimawari Suru

Never wait for instructions. Bait the hook, refill the drink, ready the net, check the drag — before anyone asks. No idle time. Ever.

#2 Keep VIPs First

VIP Saiyusen

Strict hierarchy: Watanabe > Nagatani > guests > AEGIS. Service order, line attention, shade, first drink. Track their state at all times.

#3 Don't Be the Bottleneck

Nagare wo Tomenai

Retie fast. Net instantly. Reel in when someone nearby hooks up. Respond to captain immediately. Never make everyone wait.

#4 Safety Overrides Everything

Anzen ga Subete ni Yusen

Dangerous environments everywhere. If unsafe, stop. No fish is worth an injury. Overrides all other principles.

#5 Protect Your Gear

Dougu wo Mamore

No tackle shop on Hahajima. Break it = done. Retie before it frays, rinse after sessions, avoid snags, protect from impacts.

#6 Show Energy and Fun

Genki to Tanoshisa

Hospitality atmosphere = your behavior. Be visibly positive and energetic. Enthusiasm for every catch.



Part 3

Know Your Tackle

Tsuri Dougu wo Shiru

Everything here is for subtropical saltwater on volcanic island terrain.

Fishing Tackle and Equipment

Gear to Get Started

You don't need a pricey rod and reel to catch fish. Many anglers do well fishing live bait with a simple cane pole with some line tied to the tip. When you're ready to get more advanced, give the following rod-and-reel outfits a try.

Rod-and-Reel Outfits

Spincast – Called a “push-button” rod and reel. It is inexpensive, simple to use and a good outfit for beginners. Bottom-mounted spincast outfits are available, too.



Spinning – Called an “open-face” reel. It is a good outfit for freshwater fishing. The spool is open and the line is exposed. The reel is mounted to the bottom of the rod.



Baitcasting – Called a “revolving-spool” reel because, unlike spinning reels, the spool turns when the line is cast. Larger models are used to catch catfish and bass. Beginners find this outfit difficult to use and often tangle the line when casting.



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Fig 3.1 — Rod-reel outfits: spincast (top), spinning (middle), baitcasting (bottom). You will primarily use spinning and conventional.

3.1 Rods

Type	Use	Feature
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Iso (■■■)	Rock fishing	Long 4-5m, flexible tip, strong butt
Jigging	Offshore	Short 1.5-1.8m, stiff, for heavy jigs
Light	Port/sanbashi	Medium, versatile

3.2 Reels

Spinning — Fixed spool, bail arm. Below rod. Easy to cast. Iso, sanbashi, sabiki.

Conventional — Rotating spool. More power. On top. Jigging at depth. **Always set drag before you drop.**

Never let a reel touch gunwale, ground, or sand. No replacements on Hahajima.

3.3 Hooks, Weights, Terminal Tackle



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Fig 3.2 — Hooks, sinkers (bullet, split shot, barrel/swivel), and tools.

- **Hooks** — Various sizes, barbed. Handle with care.
- **Sinkers** — Take bait down. Heavier for depth.
- **Swivels/split rings** — Prevent line twist. Essential for jigging.
- **Sabiki rigs** — Multi-hook rigs for catching baitfish at port.

3.4 Lines

Type	Properties	Use
Mono (Nylon)	Stretchy, forgiving	Leader, light rigs
Braided (PE)	Zero stretch, thin, strong	Main line for jigging
Fluorocarbon	Invisible, abrasion-resistant	Leader to hook/lure

PE #3 at depth

At 250+ meters for Onaga, thinner PE cuts current better. Less margin for error — knots must be perfect.

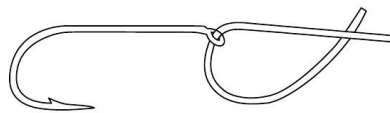
3.5 Knots You Must Know

Knot-Tying

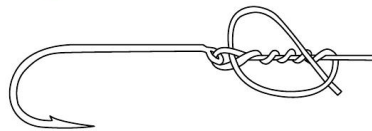
Tangles With Purpose

Fishing line requires special knots to hold the hook or lure securely when a fish is pulling against you. These three knots will cover any fishing situation, and are fairly easy to tie. Practice them at home, so you don't waste fishing time trying to remember how to do it. If your knot doesn't look right, or if your line looks worn or frayed, cut it and retie. Good fish are often lost because of bad knots.

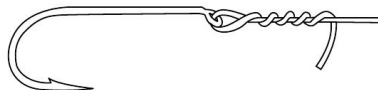
The Fisherman's Knot (Improved Clinch)



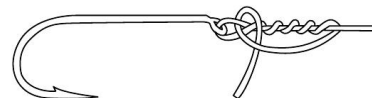
Run several inches of line through the hook eye. Don't be stingy here. Make it comfortable and easy to tie.



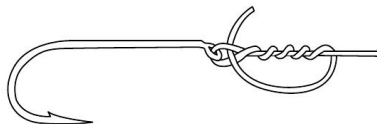
Push the loose end through the new loop you just created. Moisten the knot. This will lubricate the line and make your knot easier to tighten.



Wrap the loose end of your line around itself five or six times.



Tighten the knot slowly by pulling on the line with one hand and the hook with the other.



Pass the loose end through the loop in the line next to the eye in the hook.



Trim off the loose end of the line with a pair of fingernail clippers.

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Fig 3.3 — The Improved Clinch Knot. Practice until under 30 seconds.

FG Knot — Braid to leader. ~100% strength. Passes through guides.

Improved Clinch — Hook/sinker attachment. Thread, wrap 5-6x, moisten, pull.

Train Knot — Line-to-line. Each wraps other 5x, slide together.

3.6 Saltwater Baits

No bait shop. Securing bait is one of your most important skills.

Bait	Source	Catches
Black crab	Net at port	Reef fish
Small aji	Sabiki rig	Live bait for predators
Muroaji	Pre-supplied	Groupers, trevally, snappers
Sea urchin	From rocks	Ishigakidai
Squid	Pre-supplied	General reef

3.7 Lures and Jigs



Fig 3.4 — Artificial lures. On Ogasawara: metal jigs, inchiku jigs, soft plastics.

- **Metal jigs (300g+)** — Deep water. Expensive. Snag = major loss.
- **Inchiku jigs** — Octopus-skirt hybrid. Groupers on shallow reefs.
- **Soft plastic worms** — Akahata and Kappore near reef structure.

3.8 Clothing and Protective Gear

- **UV long-sleeve** — You burn in minutes.
- **Hat + polarized sunglasses**
- **Iso boots (■■■)** — Spiked/felt sole. Regular shoes = fatal.
- **Life jacket** — Mandatory.
- **Gloves** — PE line cuts to bone.
- **Eye protection** — Mandatory for jigging.

Part 4

Essential Skills

Kihon Sukiru



4.1 Casting

Overhead Cast

Primary cast. Rod at 2 o'clock, smooth forward to 10, release. Practice until fluid.

Roll Cast

No room behind you. Sweep rod up and forward, line rolls out. Less distance, safer.

Underhand Pitch

Short, precise. Hold lure, open bail, swing forward. Quiet and accurate for iso bait.

4.2 Jigging — Drop, Bail, Reel, Pitch

DROP — Open bail. Watch line. Stops early = bottom or fish.

BAIL — Line slack = close bail IMMEDIATELY.

REEL 8-10 — Aggressive turns off bottom. Non-negotiable. Saves your jig.

PITCH — Pump rod up, reel down. Jig darts like wounded prey.

REPEAT — Captain says up = reel fast. Don't wait.

Snag = lost jig + everyone stops. The 8-10 reel rule is insurance. Every time.

4.3 Sabiki Rig Fishing

Drop to mid-water, jig gently. Multiple fish hook at once. Transfer to bucket with fresh seawater.

4.4 Baiting

- **Crab** — Large: split, hook through body. Small: hook through rear shell.
 - **Live aji** — Hook through back or nose. Keep alive.
 - **Cut muroaji** — Strips, thread hook through twice.
 - **Sea urchin** — Crush, scoop flesh, mold on hook. Scatter shells first.
- 

4.5 Fighting and Landing

Fish bites: set hook — firm upward sweep. Fight: rod 45 degrees, pump and reel. Never reel against running drag.

Groupers dive for reef immediately. 2 seconds to force them up or line breaks.

Netting: Always head-first. On iso, position securely. On boat, step back from rail.

4.6 Hook Removal

Pliers. Always. Barbed hooks go through skin easily. Isomaguro has razor teeth. Aochibiki is slimy — use glove.

4.7 Quick Retying

Lost hooks, snapped lines — every second a VIP waits with bare line is a failure. 60 seconds max. Practice wet, standing, in wind.

Part 5

Fishing Scenarios

Tsuri no Bamen

Every session = one of three scenarios. Know them cold.

5.1 Port / Sanbashi (■■■)

Dock/seawall fishing. Bait-gathering operation + relaxed VIP fishing.

Gear

- Cigarettes + drinks
- Rain cover
- Scissors/clippers
- Small rods + reels + sabiki + sinkers
- Long net + bucket + fish bag + headlight

Tasks

Primary: **secure bait**. Crabs by net, aji by sabiki. Manage bait bucket.

Behaviors

- Check Watanabe-san. Offer drinks proactively.
- Net ready on hookup. Assist hook removal.
- Retie lost rigs fast.
- Stay together. Energy. Tidy area.

5.2 Iso / Rock Fishing (■)

MOST DANGEROUS SCENARIO. Read every word.

Boat drops you on volcanic reef for 5-6 hours. **No return**. Bait + lure fishing.

Rock Transfer

1. Life jackets ON before reaching rock.
2. One person at a time. Captain's signal.
3. STEP — don't jump — at top of swell.
4. Hands free. Gear passed by relay.
5. Check footing before putting weight down.

6. Return is MORE dangerous. Same discipline.

Safety

- Watch feet. Don't walk backward or look at phone.
- **Never turn back to sea.** Waves come in sets. Know your retreat spot.
- Gear in spray-free spots. Nothing loose near edges.

Long Haul

6 hours, 30C, no shade, no escape. Drink constantly. Electrolytes. Watch Watanabe-san for heat exhaustion. Everything you need = brought with you.

VIP Care

- Secure bait. Retie fast. Drinks + cigarettes.
- Net on hookup — critical on bad footing.
- Net head-first. Bait your own hook. Show energy.

5.3 Jigging / Offshore (■■■■)

Deep-water from boat. 100-200m depth. Big fish: Kanpachi, tuna, deep snappers.

Gear

- Jigging rods + reels
- Tackle + pliers + GLOVES
- Cooler with drinks
- EYE PROTECTION

Rules

- **Set drag** — Before every drop.
- **Watch line** — Stops = bottom or fish.
- **8-10 reels** — Off bottom. Saves jig.
- **Space out** — Don't crowd. Ready to move.
- **Slow retrieve** — When jig visible. Flying jig = danger.
- **Reel up fast** — When someone nearby hooks up.
- **Hold jigs** — Never let them swing free.
- **Step back** — From rail when fish surfaces.
- **Obey captain** — Instantly. No delays.
- **Call out** — 'Coming through!' Always.
- **BE READY** — At all times.

No bare hands on PE under tension. Gloves. No reel on gunwale.

Part 6

Taking Care of Your VIPs

VIP no Kea



6.1 The Hierarchy

Priority	Person	Responsibility
1st	Watanabe-san	Everything first.
2nd	Nagatani-san	Immediately after.
3rd	Guests	Any invited.
4th	Other AEGIS	You eat/drink/sit last.

6.2 Watanabe-san

- Forks prongs-down at meals.
- Beach chair at all locations.
- **Heat exhaustion:** #1 monitoring priority.
- **Seasickness:** Private cabin + meds + cup ramen + snacks.
- Cigarettes + drinks: never let them run out.

6.3 Nagatani-san

- Likes sweets. Reserved bar seat on ship.

6.4 On-Water Comfort

Read body language. Focused = nearby but don't hover. Resting = offer drink. Fish on = net ready before they look.

Part 7

Tackle Care and Cleaning

Dougu no Teire



7.1 Why Saltwater Destroys Gear

Salt corrodes metal in hours. Sand grinds bearings. UV weakens mono. Your gear must last 10 days. Cleaning = survival.

7.2 Post-Session Rinse

1. Rinse rods — focus on guides.
2. Rinse reels gently. No submersion, no pressure.
3. Back off all drags.
4. Rinse hooks/lures/jigs. Dry before storing.
5. Wipe handles and reel seats.
6. Stand rods upright or flat.

7.3 Reel Maintenance

- **Bail:** Clean snap open/close.
- **Drag:** Smooth turning. Gritty = salt inside.
- **Spool:** Check line for nicks.
- **Handle:** Smooth. Grinding = alert leader.

7.4 Hook & Lure Care

- Rinse, dry, dry container.
- Thumbnail sharpness test.
- Check split rings and assist hooks.

7.5 Line Inspection

Fingers along first 10m. Cut back past damage. Cloudy mono = replace. Fuzzy braid = re-spool.

7.6 Storage



- Out of sunlight.
- Bails open, drags off.
- Air-dry tackle boxes.
- Never wet gear in closed bags overnight.

Part 8

Safety and Emergency

Anzen to Kinkyu Taio

8.1 The Hahajima Reality

No hospital. Ferry 1-2x/week. No cell signal. YOU are the first responder. Prevention is the ONLY strategy.

8.2 Emergency Roles

Role	Responsibility
1. Scene Leader	Takes command.
2. Captain Contact	Comms with Nobu/Hara.
3. Recorder/Interpreter	Documents. Bridges EN/JP.
4. VIP Attendant	Stays with VIPs.

8.3 Man Overboard

DO NOT JUMP IN. 1. Throw buoyant/rope. 2. Contact captain. 3. Point continuously.

8.4 Injuries

Fracture: Don't move. Warm. Stop bleeding. Share severity.

Hook: Don't force out. Stabilize. Medical judgment.

Laceration: Direct pressure.

8.5 Heat Exhaustion

#1 iso risk. Heavy sweating, nausea, dizziness. Sweating STOPS = heat stroke = emergency.

Shade + cool water on neck/armpits + rehydrate. Watch Watanabe-san.

8.6 Dangerous Marine Life

No bare hands. Gonzui (venomous spines), Utsubo (moray), Gangaze (sea urchin), Isomaguro (razor teeth).

Ciguatera — Barafuedai

Some carry toxin. Odorless, tasteless, heat-stable. Tingling + temp reversal hours later.

If in doubt, don't eat.

8.7 Communication

Hand signs finalized in training Block 3: Fish on / Reel up / Coming through / Stop / Emergency

Don't carry alone. Share immediately. VIP safety > catch.

Part 9

Dos and Don'ts

Yarubeki/Yatte wa Ikenai



9.1 Universal Dos

- DO:** Life jacket on boat + rocks.
- DO:** Set drag before dropping.
- DO:** Rinse gear after every session.
- DO:** Carry Watanabe-san's items.
- DO:** Know first-aid location.
- DO:** Retie worn line.
- DO:** Call out passing behind.
- DO:** Net head-first.
- DO:** Respond to captain instantly.
- DO:** Share problems — never alone.

9.2 Universal Don'ts

- DON'T:** Turn back to sea.
 - DON'T:** Jump during transfer.
 - DON'T:** Carry gear during transfer.
 - DON'T:** Let jig swing free.
 - DON'T:** Handle PE without gloves.
 - DON'T:** Touch creatures bare-handed.
 - DON'T:** Force barbed hooks out.
 - DON'T:** Hit reel on gunwale.
 - DON'T:** Stand idle.
 - DON'T:** Let VIP supplies run out.
 - DON'T:** Walk backward on rocks.
 - DON'T:** Phone while walking terrain.
- 

Part 10

Pre-Trip Training

Shuppatsu Mae Kunren



10.1 Timeline (June 9-18)

Dates	Block	Content
Jun 9-11	Fundamentals	Knots, baiting, rigging. Knots first.
Jun 12-15	Behaviors	Sanbashi/Jigging/Iso drills + Serving
Jun 16-17	Rehearsal	Hand signs + Emergency scenarios
Jun 18	Pre-Departure	Safety briefing + dry run + packing
Jun 19	DEPARTURE	—

10.2 Skill Assignments

Each person masters one skill, teaches the team. Assignments by Matsumoto + Nate.

10.3 Final Briefing (June 18)

Full safety briefing + physical rock transfer practice on land + final packing check against inventory.

Appendices



A Master Gear Checklist

PORT

- ☐ Cigarettes+lighter
- ☐ Drinks
- ☐ Rain cover
- ☐ Scissors
- ☐ Small rods+reels
- ☐ Sabiki+sinkers
- ☐ Long net
- ☐ Bucket w/ rope
- ☐ Fish bag
- ☐ Headlight

ISO

- ☐ Cigarettes+lighter
- ☐ Drinks (6+hrs)
- ☐ Chair/pad
- ☐ Iso rod+reel+tackle+bait
- ☐ LIFE JACKET
- ☐ Lunch+electrolytes
- ☐ Sunscreen+hat+UV
- ☐ Net
- ☐ First-aid kit

JIGGING

- ☐ Jigging rods+reels
- ☐ Tackle+pliers
- ☐ GLOVES
- ☐ Cooler+drinks
- ☐ EYE PROTECTION

☐ LIFE JACKET

☐ First-aid kit

B Knot Quick Reference

FG Knot

Loop leader, weave braid 15-20x

Half-hitch 6x alternating

Trim. Must pass guides.

Improved Clinch

Thread eye 6in

Wrap 5-6x

Through small loop then big loop

Moisten, pull, trim.

Train Knot

Overlap 15cm

A wraps B 5x, thread

B wraps A 5x, thread

Moisten, slide together, trim.

C Hand Signals

Signal	Meaning
Fist pump up	Fish on!
Circular wind	Reel up
Palm forward	Stop/Hold
Arm wave	Emergency
Point+tap shoulder	Coming through

D Emergency Card (Laminate)

MAN OVERBOARD	Don't jump. Throw float. Contact captain. Point.
FRACTURE	Don't move. Warm. Stop bleeding. Share.
HOOK	Don't force. Stabilize. Medical.
HEAT	Shade. Cool. Rehydrate. Stroke if no sweat.
CREATURE	No bare hands. Clean. Pressure. Medical.

E Tackle Cleaning Checklist

DAILY

- ☐ Rods rinsed
- ☐ Guides inspected
- ☐ Reels rinsed gently
- ☐ Drags backed off
- ☐ Hooks/lures dried
- ☐ Line inspected 10m
- ☐ Handles wiped
- ☐ Stored out of sun

END OF TRIP

- ☐ Full freshwater rinse
- ☐ Reels dried+oiled
- ☐ Rusty hooks discarded
- ☐ Lines checked
- ☐ Jig inventory
- ☐ Guides checked
- ☐ Life jackets inspected
- ☐ First-aid restocked
- ☐ Inventory reconciliation



You have read the guide. You know the principles, tackle, skills, scenarios, and rules. Now train, practice, prepare. When you step onto Hahajima, you will be ready.

Good luck, angler. Ganbatte.



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